

School Committee Meeting - Notes - April 20, 2020 - Via Zoom

Pursuant to Governor Baker's March 12, 2020 Order Suspending Certain Provisions of the Open Meeting Law, G.L. c. 30A, §18, and the Governor's March 15, 2020 Order imposing strict limitations on the number of people that may gather in one place, this meeting of the Medford School Committee will be conducted via remote participation to the greatest extent possible. Specific information and the general guidelines for remote participation by members of the public and/or parties with a right and/or requirement to attend this meeting can be found on the City of Medford website, at www.medfordma.org. For this meeting, members of the public who wish to listen or watch the meeting may do so by accessing the meeting link contained herein. No in-person attendance of members of the public will be permitted, but every effort will be made to ensure that the public can adequately access the proceedings in real time, via technological means. In the event that we are unable to do so, despite best efforts, we will post on the City of Medford or Medford Community Media websites an audio or video recording, transcript, or other comprehensive record of proceedings as soon as possible after the meeting.

The meeting can be viewed through Medford Community Media on Comcast Channel 22 and Verizon Channel 43 at 5:30 p.m.

Since the meeting will be held remotely, participants can log or call in by using the following link or call-in number:

(1) [Medford School Committee Meeting on Zoom](#) (2) Telephone Information (choose any one of the following and then follow the prompts)

- (a) 1-929-205-6099
- (b) 1-312-626-6799
- (c) 1-301-715-8592
- (d) 1-346-248-7799
- (e) 1-669-900-6833
- (f) 1-253-215-8782

(i) Enter this meeting ID when prompted: 975 2504 7259

Additionally, questions or comments can be submitted during the meeting by emailing medfordsc@medford.k12.ma.us. Those submitting must include the following information:

1) Your first and last name

2) Your Medford street address

3) Your question or comment

I. Roll Call (7-0) and Salute the Flag

II. Approval of Minutes of April 6, 2020 - Ms.Kreatz makes motion to approve, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot. All in favor? Motion passes

III. Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds and Approval of Payrolls - Ms.Graham makes motion to approves, seconded by Mr. Ruseau - Roll Call vote - (7-0) Motion passes

IV. Report of Secretary - None

V. Report of Committees

1. Budget Committee of the Whole Meeting- April 6, 2020-Mayor Lungo-Koehn Motion to approve by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. McLaughlin, motion passes.

2. Special Education/ Behavioral Health Subcommittee - April 14, 2020-Ms. McLaughlin - We met last week to introduce the new subcommittee and it's members. Over 25 people attended. We discussed the behavioral health (trauma) component as well as the special education component. We decided to meet every 3rd Thursday of the month. Every other month will focus on behavioral health and then the next month, special education. Are there any questions? Motion to approve by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

VI. Community Participation - None

VII. Report of Superintendent -

1. Superintendent's Updates and Comments -

The Middle School Lottery went very well via Zoom. I thank Dr. Ricciardelli and Ms. Myles for all of their hard work in organizing this information. The lottery numbers are

posted on our website and blog. I want to thank Ms. Goldsberry for establishing a special tab on the website to access the lottery. Mr. Tucci and Downs will do a remotely based orientation if needed. OR go forward with the scheduled orientations May 6 & 7th. Congratulations are in order for Maria D'Orsi, the librarian at Medford High School. Maria was named the 2020 recipient of the Super Librarian Award from the Massachusetts School Library Association. We are grateful to the Teamsters 25, who donated liquid hand sanitizer in 375 mil bottles for all of our custodians. The hand sanitizer was made by the distiller MS Walker which is a family owned business based in New England, who stopped their production of alcohol and changed the business over to making a very strong alcohol-based hand sanitizer. According to Molly Laden, Director of Media, Library and Technology, a link has been established for anyone who is in need of technical support during this school closure at techsupport@medford.k12.ma.us. The College Board has informed our Guidance Department that due to COVID-19, SAT'S will not be administered during the remaining school year. We are always expressing how grateful we are for our health care professionals during the COVID-19 crisis. Last Sunday, in the Boston Globe, one of our own, Mustang Ricky Cormio, a 2002 graduate, was featured serving as a paramedic on the front lines for Cataldo Ambulance. Ricky is the son of Vocational Electrical teacher Richard Cormio and his wife Teresa. Ricky Cormio is just one of so many Mustangs that are currently serving us during this pandemic, whether in the medical field, in public safety, or in our grocery stores. Yesterday on Fox 25 News, our own Columbus School Nurse, Karen Roberto was featured assisting the Board of Health with contact tracing. We all enjoyed an uplifting parade that the McGlynn teachers and staff hosted for their students last Tuesday. Additionally, I want to thank the Mayor for also lifting our spirits with her Medford Strong video which featured Medford residents indicating who they are staying home for. In discussions with the Commissioner of Education for the Commonwealth, we are awaiting the decision of Governor Baker as to whether we will be returning to school on May 4th. However, in light of the extended closure, the MCAS assessment will not be given this year. We are expecting to hear his decision at some point this week. As decisions are made, we will relay them to you.

2. Report on COVID-19 Update - Toni Wray & MaryAnn O'Connor

Ms. Wray - Massachusetts had a surge in diagnoses. As of today 519 positive cases in Medford. Our elderly population has been hit hard. School nurses are doing contact tracing and connecting with elderly as part of the Mayor's Are You Okay Program, as well as assisting with Grab and Go food distribution. I want to recognize the stress everyone is experiencing. But please stay home, keep up with good - hand washing and please wear a mask when going out. Mayor - Thank you Toni and thank you to your nurses for helping with contact tracing and over 11,000 seniors have been called. We are beginning a second

round of calls on Wednesday. Ms. McLaughlin - Thank you Mayor for establishing the Are you Okay Program. There is a special place in heaven for you. The seniors are grateful and it has brought the community together. Mayor - Thank you. If any residents are willing to make calls or make deliveries, please reach out to my office. We will need to complete a CORI check. Also get MRC certified. I want to also thank members of the City Council and School Committee who have made calls as well for this program. Ms. Van der Kloot - The response on the calls are so positive. Thank you Mayor for everything you are doing during this crisis. Mayor - The hardest hit is our elderly population and nursing home residents. Additionally, we are in touch with the Massachusetts Department of Public Health and Secretary Sudder's Office.

3. Report on Negotiated Transportation Contract Payment for Remainder of School Year - Ms. Patterson - I have been on numerous calls with the Department of Education and they have directed us to maintain a payment structure with Eastern Bus Company, so when we go back to the regular school schedule, there will be drivers. Our estimates are the low end of the per diem rate. We are on the back end of our 5 year contract. The bid for a new contract has currently been pushed out to May. Most cities are negotiating 70-75% of their daily school bus runs. In negotiations with the owner of Eastern Bus, we have provided a separate letter of agreement, which supplements the current contract. The town of Brookline's legal department has vetted this process and the districts using Eastern bus have negotiated a collaborated rate. Drivers would receive regular payment. They have not filed for unemployment at this time. Medford Public Schools would pay the bus company a portion of the base contract rate so they are accessible when closure ends. Ms. Van der Kloot - Thank you for working this out for the district. I make a motion for a roll call vote. Mr. Ruseau - I have a question, in the 4th paragraph where it says, whereas, there is a star. Does that mean anything? Ms. Patterson - an established payment. Mr. Ruseau - Okay in section 3G - would we have any way to know if they have received payments or loans? Ms. Patterson - federal or state loan is public information, so we would be aware. Mr. Ruseau - any information on the availability of those grants? Ms. Patterson - federal or state grants wouldn't happen until maybe May or June so next fiscal year a credit could be issued if Eastern Bus received any such grants. Mayor - At this point, the second stimulus package doesn't have any funding included for cities and towns. Ms. Van der Kloot - regarding our small transportation? Ms. Patterson - prior service is being paid now. Phase 2 of these negotiations will be with the small transportation companies. We haven't had that discussion as of yet, needing to finalize the yellow bus transportation first. The Department of Education wanted to do large transportation first. Mayor - This will carry us through? The Governor said he would decide on school this week. Ms. Patterson - Yes, until the end of this school year or when we are allowed to return. Mayor - What are other districts doing? Maybe some are waiting on the Governor first. Ms. Patterson - Brookline arranged

this whole process. Motion on the floor to accept this proposal by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Kreatz. Roll Call Vote - 7-0. Motion passes.

4. Report on Kindergarten Online Enrollment - Ms. Caldwell - We began remote registration on April 7th. It's a coordinated effort between Maria Ibrahim from the Parent Information Center, Stephanie McCann from the Nurses Office, and Kim Myles will check School Brains. 147 registered prior to March 14th, then we had a 3 week gap. Since that time we have enrolled 33 more students, so we have 188 total so far. We are certain our registrations will increase. Our plan is to roll out Grades 1-12 by May 4th and then we will follow with MEEP and the lottery process on that. I want to thank Toni Wray & her staff, Maria, Kim and remind parents to register on school brains, parents should check to be sure everything has been received. Ms. McLaughlin - If we are going back maybe plexiglass should be placed at the Parent Information Center? Ms. Caldwell - I'm concerned with the area itself, I would defer to Ms. Wray and Mr. McLaughlin. Mr. Ruseau - Can we add a question regarding Dyslexia diagnosis? Ms. Caldwell - I will check into that for you. Ms. Graham - I'm excited that we are offering online registration whether our buildings are open or not - not logistically feasible. Have we done a push to local pre schools? Ms. Caldwell - We did not do a formal push. We did do one to our private schools. I will reach out to the pre-schools. Ms. Graham - Before the school closure, the Engagement Subcommittee was to meet to discuss the Kindergarten registration process. I would like to do that before Ms. Caldwell leaves. Also, what about parent visiting day? This is especially important for first time parents. We realize that might not be an option right now, but what can we do if we don't go back? Ms. Caldwell - That hasn't been discussed. I'm sure principals would welcome zoom meetings. Hopefully, playdates will be able to be held over the summer. There has been a silver lining to all of this I suppose. Online registration is filling our need for parents who work and are unable to get to the Parent Information Center. Motion to accept the report by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.

5. Report on Student Engagement during School Closure - Dr. Edouard-Vincent

We are in the process of gathering data and at this point, there are 38 students in the entire district that we have had no contact with. The district is closely monitoring 350 students who are general education, EL and special education. Teachers are working collaboratively with us. Some of the students are not as engaged as we'd like them to be. We are all working diligently to re-engage these students. I have been in touch with Police Chief Buckley who will assist us in trying to reach the 38 students by doing a wellness check. I appreciate Dr. Cushing developing this form that was sent to the principals and for Ms. Myles for quantifying the data. Mr. Ruseau - I'm very happy to see this report. What does engaged mean? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Our first priority is to make contact with every

single student. We think one student may have moved to California. Regarding the 350, what I meant was their remote participation has been very inconsistent, so classroom teachers are concerned. It's not always a connectivity issue. Students with access to the internet still aren't fully engaged. To break it out - 228 are considered general ed - 58 spec ed not actively engaged and 64 EL students not actively engaged. Ms. Van der Kloot - 38 students? Do we know if that is multiple children in one family? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - that is our next step. Ms. Van der Kloot - This is valuable information about where we are. The tables are very clear. Thank you. Ms. Graham - Can the next report explain what closely monitored means? Also do we know who has technology access, access to the internet, and a one-to-one device at home? Do we capture this data in school brains or place we can record this information? There are two students not reached at McGlynn? Ms. Guarino - updated to only 1 child at this point. We have reached the other child. Dr. Cushing - all of our principals have done a great job to reach out to students. Everyone is going above and beyond. Our middle school principals will be changing their numbers as they have reached students over this past weekend. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Due to sporadic work production in one or more classes, that student needs to be monitored. We also have to remember, we do not know the financial situation of each family. Ms. Graham - We should have a place that this information is gathered and kept for future use. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We can definitely do that. Ms. McLaughlin - Thank you to the staff who made the effort to reach these students and Chief Buckley for providing wellness checks on our non contact students. How will you work it out for the closely monitored students as to what happens next? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Data is important as it is knowledge. We are reaching the majority of the district but the 350 is our next body of work. Another critical part is the stress of the situation, so Stacey Schulman has been involved to try to meet their social emotional needs. We know that each student probably has a different set of needs. A parent or family member could be ill, the internet might be inconsistent at their home, or the students might have to work. Ms. McLaughlin - A narrative of what happened with those 350 students would be very helpful. Ms. Galusi - Part of the inconsistent work requires us to closely monitor. I am glad that Ms. Schulman has continued the lunch bunches program which helps students connect with support. Ms. Kreatz - I do want to gain clarity here. What about parents who do not want their child to participate in a zoom meeting? I want to make sure that it is not held against them. Can I reconfirm this? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - If some families do not believe in remote learning, there are options to turn off the camera, but students can still hear and speak. I realize some parents don't trust the security of it. We are willing to work with those families. But if we were not able to come up with a medical reason, or a really good reason why the student has not been engaging, it would be hard for that student to receive a passing grade. The expectation is that students complete the work. If families need resources, we can help them, so they need to reach out to us. Ms. Kreatz - Ye, but is zoom required? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - If a student is in communication with the

teacher and doing other work, that is fine. We just don't want our students to think they do not have to be accountable. Dr. Cushing - Those parents should reach out to their principals with any concerns, so we can assist them and work with their students. Ms. Kreatz - Are there any families that are still awaiting a device? If school is out longer, will there be another deployment? Dr. Cushing - Some principals have delivered to someone's homes. However, the danger to staff has to be limited for a safe pickup. Mayor - Let me know if you need a chromebook delivered, we can assist. Dr. Kay - Please note, it is not just whether a student participates in school via zoom, but letters are being sent home, no response. You call the family phone, and the inbox messaging is full. Mr. Ruseau - Can any WiFi Hotspots be purchased for students who don't have access? Also how will we collect the chromebooks at the end of all this? Mayor - My office did call Comcast and Verizon and we are awaiting returning calls. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I'll follow up with Ms. Laden. We have heard some school buses have wifi. But students would have to be spaced out if that were an option. However, we need to continue to reach out to those 350 students to find out if the reason for not being in touch is indeed connectivity. Dr. Cushing -I would be ideal if we could identify single hot spots vs. on a bus. What would be the better bang for our cost? We really need to plan for the future for this. We need, as a community, to have a contingency plan since it's such a vital part of everyday life. Ms. Graham - Regarding the future, I make a motion that the Engagement Planning Committee host a series of roundtables to formulate a 2020 fall plan. I am very concerned about the administration taking this on all on their own. Seconded by Ms. McLaughlin - Motion passes. Motion to accept Superintendent's Report, made by Ms. McLaughlin, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

6. Report on SEPAC Survey - Tonya Sullivan, SEPAC Co-Chair - Ms. Sullivan - Thank you for the distance learning plan. We are all learning as we know. Please note that the results I'm speaking about will be available on our site at the end of this meeting. We had 226 respondents to this survey. Some of the results were:

68% - lack structure, There is a need for social emotional learning, regression of academic skills, lack of therapeutic support, varied contact with teachers, some contact with therapists.

Concerns - The feelings of being overwhelmed. Regression issues, IEP meetings, continuity of assignments/platforms, inconsistent work assignments, and 504 implementation

Parents Suggestions: 1to 1 remote meetings with teachers/specialists, IEP team meetings or a check in with the ETL, virtual support groups, pPhone calls from ETL's or teacher, regular feedback from teachers/administrators

Ms. Bowen - When was this survey taken? Ms. Sullivan - March 29th until this past Saturday. Ms. Bowen - Some of these questions might have been addressed by the distance learning plan but other questions can be discussed now or in a round table format separately. The special education department is in the process of rolling out particular plans for each child, with specific schedules, so parents/guardians can call and ask questions. These plans are not set in stone. They are flexible to help us to improve the remote learning plans. IEP meetings are being guided by DESE. First priority will be our Pre K to K, 6th grade to high schools and then we will try to schedule after those have been completed. We received a Telehealth waiver, based on individual students' needs. We are all in a new world, and communication is key. If you are struggling as a parent, please reach out to me directly, so we can best try to meet everyone's needs. Ms. McLaughlin - Thank you Tanya and Alex. This report will be on the district website and the SEPAC page. I know some parents are in initial evaluations and in the state of limbo. We need to communicate. The report gives us quality data. It can be run again, or it can be translated. We encourage the community to reach out to SEPAC, but 30% response during a pandemic is great! Ms. Graham - What surveys were not completed or not accepted? Alex - Multiple choice questions had to be answered. Ms. Graham - Did you have to take the survey multiple times for multiple children? Can you break that down? Alex - No. We followed the same form that the Medford Public Schools uses. Ms. Van der Kloot - Parents who are struggling really hit my heart. But our teachers have gone above and beyond and I thank them for their dedication. Ms. Sullivan - I agree. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Thank you for presenting this data. We also have Ms. Douglas from the teacher's union in attendance. In addition, Dr. Cushing also has a report regarding student data. We are in unprecedented times, and Massachusetts has been recognized as one of the leaders in distant learning in the country. But, we are building a plane and flying it at the same time. We must look at our challenges, but applaud all the good work being done collaboratively together. Ms. Bowen - Can we schedule a time to go over the survey? Ms. Sullivan - Great. Mr. Ruseau - My perspectives - I didn't realize that Pre K staff is reaching out, fabulous! Mayor - motion to accept committee report made by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. McLaughlin. Ms. Douglas - I would just like to say that I appreciate the positive responses on teachers reaching out. Everyone is working, but I think that everyone also needs to take a deep breath. Medford is light years ahead of other communities. Thank you Paulette and Paul for the comments. Mayor - Motion passes.

7. Report on MPS Distance Learning Survey - Dr. Peter J. Cushing

The survey started Mar 27th- Apr 5th, and it provided a tremendous amount of information. Teachers who never used google classroom got up to speed quickly. All schools

participated. Social emotional responses have helped Ms. Schulman and our principals prepare and reach out to support our families. The communication has been clear, important and people are understanding it. They gave the school leaders high marks. Other points from the survey:

Functionality - Google Classroom - 58%, Average time on academics - 17% more than 3 hours - 32% 2-3 hours

Biggest challenges of distance learning: I'm still working a full time job and providing the education is tough. I need more computers for all the work to be completed. Some parents of students with special needs are struggling.

We are awaiting further guidance from the state.

Ms Van der Kloot - Was the survey translated? Dr. Cushing - We did not provide a separate survey that was translated line by line. We received one response in Portuguese. Ms. Van der Kloot - How much time is recommended? K-12 - seems different for elementary, vs. middle, vs. high school. Can it be included in the next survey?. Dr. Cushing - I will do that. Ms. Van der Kloot - Also, could a question be added asking how students are feeling? Dr. Cushing - Yes. Ms. McLaughlin - I advocate to add a question for the actual teachers who are with their children and teaching as well. Motion to accept the report by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. McLaughlin, motion passes.

8. Report on Student Opportunity Act (SOA) survey and application - Dr. Peter J. Cushing - On March 9th I presented this report to the School Committee. The SOA is designed to infuse much needed money for struggling districts. Medford is supposed to receive \$138 per student, so we are expecting the minimum. A survey was supposed to go out last Saturday, but unfortunately I had connectivity issues. The survey will be available in all languages, just click on the language needed. However, the Commonwealth has lost \$5 billion in revenues, so there is concern that these funds may not be realized. The deadline has been pushed back. Ms. Graham - Another meeting of the Engagement Subcommittee, that was delayed due to the shutdown. We should be prepared to look at those results. I make a motion to move this to the Engagement Subcommittee, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

9. Report on Senior Class of 2020 Events - Mr. D'Alleva & Dr. Peter Cushing and Senior Class advisor Ms. Donlon: Dr. Cushing - We are committed to doing as much as we can for our senior class. Really, an in person grad ceremony after 13 years is due them! We are committed as school leaders, but we don't know the timeline! We are working behind the

scenes on some things. I remember discussing the senior class with Headmaster D'Alleva on March 12th. It was always front and center for us. Mr. D'Alleva - The hardest part is we don't know when things will be updated. If we go back May 4th, it would present a different scenario, then if we don't go back at all. But there are NO cancellations, but rather we are in postponement mode. What I most want to do is hear from our students. Our student representative, Isabelle DeSouza, is on this call. I do want to hear parent input as well. Ms. Donlon - We have scheduled a zoom meeting for senior families at 5 PM this Wednesday. My heart breaks for the Class of 2020. That is where we are at this time. Ms. Van der Kloot - I received letters as well. I am glad it will not if, but when. Mr. Ruseau - Can we utilize the graduation line item rather than depending upon the community to fund our senior class events? Ms. Kreatz - I am thrilled to hear you were committed to this class. Maybe we could post a message on the electronic billboard or on the large moveable message boards? Mayor - I know Dr. Cushing has some ideas as well as Mr. D'Alleva. Mr. Ruseau - I have a question from the community from Susan Brosnahan - What is the final day for seniors? Mr. D'Alleva - We can't decide that until we know when we are returning to school. If we don't go back, May 4th, then we are in uncharted territory, so I can't answer that right now. Ms. McLaughlin - So glad to hear from day one you were going to make sure our students would be celebrated - Should senior parents reach out to you? Dr. Cushing - Yes. Me or Headmaster D'Alleva. There is a new Medford Public School Facebook Page, and the Senior Parents also have their own facebook page. There are 303 students in class. Some have mentioned banners throughout the city. But we are unsure of cost? Ms. McLaughlin - Winchester has lawn signs. Community members might want to donate? Ms. Van der Kloot - Any updates on advanced placement exams? Have they been cancelled? Mr. D'Alleva - No it will be an online exam. Ms. McLaughlin - I have heard from Guidance that a lot of colleges are waving SAT's ? Mr. D'Alleva - It depends on the school. Some are and some are not. Ms. DeSouza - We have a Senior Instagram account for memories. Seniors are asked to DM us where they are going to college. We all feel confused. We urge more communication between school administration and the senior class. Mr. D'Alleva - There is also a Class of 2020 Memories on facebook. Ms. Donlon - One of the things that we shared with the class is showing them the senior gift. It's a water bottle and the students were thrilled. Mr. D'Alleva - The caps & gowns are in. Mr. Blauch and are discussing how to distribute them. Mayor - can discuss that in more detail in two weeks. Motion to accept the report by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.

VIII. Old Business -

Mr. Ruseau - On the calendar I have, I believe the highlighted dates are wrong? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I think you have the calendar that was attached to Ms. Patterson's

transportation report.

IX. Communications - none.

X. New Business - From Ms. Van der Kloot - Please let us remember Krystle Campbell, on this anniversary of the Boston Marathon bombings.

School Committee Resolution Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Raymond Quill. Mr. Quill was the father of cosmetology teacher Julianne Mauro.

School Committee Resolution Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Anne Glencross. Anne served as a Senior Account Clerk for 47 years at the Medford Public Schools, working at the Medford Vocational Technical High School.

School Committee Resolution Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Brian Freda. Mr. Freda was the brother of Medford High School teacher Lisa Dunphy.

School Committee Resolution Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Margaret (Peggy) Small, a former Medford Public Schools School Lunch staff person and mother of former HVAC teacher Robert (Bobby) Small

School Committee Resolution Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Grace Lauria. Mrs. Lauria was the grandmother of Medford High School Special Education teacher Sabrina Huether.

Ms Van der Kloot - I would also like to say, that I was at Medford High School to sign bills and I witnessed so many employees lined up at the bottom of the hill while Annie Glencross' funeral passed by.

XI. Negotiations and Legal Matters

Mayor - Our next regular School Committee Meeting is May 4th at 5:30 PM - Budget Hearing - will be held from 4:00 - 5:30 PM. Motion to adjourn offered by Mr. Ruseau and seconded by Ms. Graham. Motion passes. Meeting adjourned at 8:19 PM